



The personality traits of workplace bullies are often shared by their victims: Is there a dark side to victims?

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ARTICLE INFO

Article history:

Received 11 July 2012

Received in revised form 27 November 2012

Accepted 28 November 2012

Available online 25 December 2012

Keywords:

Bullying
Personality
Machiavellianism
Narcissism
Psychoticism
Aggression
Sensation seeking

ABSTRACT

In this exploratory study, we examined the extent to which both workplace bullies and victims possess bully-typifying traits, using a 22-item scale that simultaneously measures perpetrators and targets of negative workplace acts. Participants were 224 Canadian university students aged 18–47 with prior work experience. Bivariate correlational analyses determined that bullying others was positively associated with measures of Machiavellianism, narcissism, psychoticism, aggression, and disinhibition. Being a victim was positively associated with the same Machiavellianism, narcissism, psychoticism, and aggression measures. Hierarchical regression analyses indicated that an “alternative dark triad” of Machiavellianism, narcissism, and psychoticism related significantly to bullying scores; while psychoticism and Machiavellianism related significantly to victim scores. Aggression and sensation seeking measures failed to account for significant variance in bully or victim scores beyond the triad variables. The vast majority of bullies (89.7%) and many victims (41.7%) were bully/victims, operationally defined as being both perpetrators and targets at least once per week in the last 6 months. Researchers and employers would do well to recognize the presence of bully/victims in their efforts to understand and reduce workplace bullying.

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1. Introduction

An understanding of workplace bullying may help reduce the health and emotional costs for victims. Bullied employees are at increased risk of physical and psychological problems including depression, psychosomatic symptoms, post-traumatic stress, and coronary heart disease (Einarsen, Hoel, & Notelaers, 2009; Lee & Brotheridge, 2006; Lutgen-Sandvik, Tracy, & Alberts, 2007). Workplace bullying has been cited with prevalence rates of 46.8%, 24.1%, and 15.8%, at least once weekly in American, Finnish, and Danish studies, respectively (Lutgen-Sandvik et al., 2007). The Negative Acts Questionnaire-Revised (NAQ-R) is a widely-used measure of bullying victimization which asks employees to report the extent to which they have experienced a variety of negative acts at work. We modified the victim-oriented NAQ-R into a Perpetrator-Target Scale (PTS), creating “bully” and “victim” subscales, which simultaneously measure both perpetrators and targets of bullying.

Bullies and victims appear to share personality traits that are more typically attributed to bullies. Scattered observations have

found that victims possess such bully-typifying traits as disagreeableness, dominance, and aggression (Archer, Ireland, & Power, 2007; Glaso, Nielsen, & Einarsen, 2009; Olweus, 1993). Bullies and victims may share personality traits because many are both perpetrators and targets of negative acts. In fact, Lee and Brotheridge (2006) found that 83% of bullies were also victims, and 50% of victims were also bullies, on a once weekly basis. Because victims are often bullies, we suspect that they possess some of the stable and enduring personality traits consistent with the bully role.

In addition, bullying researchers have recognized that the personalities of some persons are sufficiently provocative that others may respond by bullying them (Olweus, 1993; Matthiesen & Einarsen, 2007). Andersson and Pearson (1999), for example, have described the process whereby employees feel justified in responding aggressively to annoying co-workers whose behavior and attitudes fall outside of social norms. Many provocative personalities are also bully/victims, as they may be perpetrators as well as targets (Matthiesen & Einarsen, 2007). The provocative traits of victims range from the aggressive, to those deemed “annoying” or socially inappropriate (Andersson & Pearson, 1999; Matthiesen & Einarsen, 2007), labels that are likewise applicable to the traits of bullies. As an example, the bully-typifying trait verbal aggression may be directly associated with the bullying of others (Parkins, Fishbein, & Ritchey, 2006). It is also, however, associated with argumentativeness (Diamond, 2005), a possible

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“annoying” factor that may provoke others to bully those who score highly on the trait.

In this study, we have compiled a number of personality traits that have been either empirically or theoretically linked with bullying others; we expect victims to share these traits. Machiavellianism, narcissism, and subclinical psychopathy, the so-called “dark triad” of personality, have been associated with bullying. Psychopathy was most strongly associated with bullying, followed by Machiavellianism and narcissism in a recent workplace bullying study (Baughman, Dearing, Giammarco, & Vernon, 2012). Those high in Machiavellianism are believed to “employ aggressive, exploiting, and devious behavior to achieve personal and organizational goals,” with little thought for the welfare of others (Ricks & Fraedrich, 1999, p. 197–198). High Machiavellian employees have self-reported as more comfortable with violating others’ rights than low scorers (Winter, Stylianou, & Giacalone, 2004). Narcissistic individuals are grandiose, with a sense of entitlement and superiority which may cause them to feel entitled to treat others badly. Narcissism scores in undergraduate students have been found to be positively associated with self- and observer-reports of antisocial behavior, on a measure which included bullying items (Paulhus, Robins, Trzesniewski, & Tracy, 2004).

Those high in subclinical psychopathy are more likely to perform antisocial behaviors and are typically cold, manipulative, impulsive, thrill-seeking, and distrustful (LeBreton, Binning, & Adorno, 2006). Eysenckian psychoticism was derived as a complex supertrait in the “big three” model that addresses the major factors of personality (Eysenck & Eysenck, 1994). This measure has been characterized as a construct related to, or on continuum with, subclinical psychopathy (Corr, 2010; Zuckerman, 1991). Considerable theory and research supports the instrument’s utility for normal populations, involving hundreds of studies in many countries. This broadly heterogeneous scale addresses a large range of subtraits, many of which are of relevance for bullying research. The high scorer is unempathetic, manipulative, irresponsible, risk-taking (disregarding danger), inhumane, impulsive, insensitive, hostile (even to own kin), aggressive (even to loved ones), unconventional (with a liking for odd and unusual things), under socialized, disrespectful of laws, manners, and traditions, likes to upset and make fools of others, is troublesome, and expresses antisocial attitudes and behaviors (Eysenck & Eysenck, 1994). A junior version of this scale has correlated positively with bullying in school children (Connolly & O’Moore, 2003).

Aggression and sensation seeking are also of interest to bullying research. Workplace bullying has correlated significantly with Buss-Perry Aggression subscales in employed college students (Parkins et al., 2006). Zuckerman (2007) concluded that sensation seeking was associated with aggression and antisocial behavior, finding the disinhibition and boredom susceptibility components most related to aggression scale scores. Bullies, like young offenders (Gudjonsson & Sigurdsson, 2007), may perpetrate for excitement, to relieve monotony, or through low impulse control.

In this study, we examine the extent to which victims and bullies possess bully typifying traits. It is hypothesized that the bully-typifying traits Machiavellianism, narcissism, Eysenckian psychoticism, aggression, and sensation seeking will associate positively with both bully and victim scores.

2. Method

2.1. Participants and procedure

A sample of 224 undergraduate students was recruited from psychology and other programs (business, engineering, computer science) at three Canadian universities. All participants were re-

quired to have been employed at the time of, and for 6 months prior to, the study. Respondents completed a test battery consisting of personality instruments, a 22-item scale which simultaneously measures perpetrators and targets of negative workplace acts (the PTS), and a series of demographic items. Signed consent was given for participating in a study involving “workplace behaviors.” Participant pool recruits received extra credit in their psychology courses, and nonpool recruits received gift certificates for the value of five Canadian dollars for participation. There were no statistically significant differences between the extra credit and gift certificate groups in terms of scores on the perpetrator and target subscales.

2.2. Measures of personality

Machiavellianism was measured on the 10-item Machiavellianism Scale (Allsopp, Eysenck, & Eysenck, 1991) ($\alpha = .79$), and narcissism on the 16-item Narcissistic Personality Inventory (NPI-16; Ames, Rose, & Anderson, 2006) ($\alpha = .75$). The Psychoticism subscale of the Revised Eysenck Personality Questionnaire (EPQ-R; Eysenck & Eysenck, 1994), slightly abridged for internal consistency reliability in the current sample, measured psychoticism ($\alpha = .66$ for 22 items).

To measure aggression, we used three subscales from the Buss-Perry Aggression Questionnaire, Short Form (BPAQ-SF; Diamond, 2005): Anger, Hostility, and Verbal Aggression ($\alpha = .81$ for 8 items). The Brief Sensation Seeking Scale (BSSS; Hoyle, Stephenson, Palmgreen, Lorch, & Donohew, 2002), an 8-item abbreviated counterpart of the widely-used Sensation Seeking Scale Form V (Zuckerman, 1994), was used to measure sensation seeking ($\alpha = .78$).

2.3. Measures of bullying and victimization

The Negative Acts Questionnaire-Revised (NAQ-R) was developed as a comprehensive-yet-brief scale to survey the negative acts experienced by victims of workplace bullying. It consists of 22 items ranging from “opinions and views ignored” to “threats of violence or abuse.” The items are measured on a 5-point frequency scale ranging from “never” to “daily.”

Support has been provided for the construct validity of the NAQ-R. High scorers report more health complaints, reduced performance, increased absenteeism due to illness, and a greater desire to change jobs than low scorers. Those employees who experience severe bullying are more likely to report low organizational satisfaction, high stress from relationships with colleagues, and more autocratic leadership than those who experience occasional bullying (Einarsen et al., 2009). In terms of internal consistency, Cronbach alphas of .81–.92 were reported by Lutgen-Sandvik et al. (2007) for Negative Acts Questionnaire (NAQ) measures.

We modified the NAQ-R, intending to retain the scale’s desirable psychometric qualities, while at the same time generating an item-by-item measure of bullying others that corresponds with the original victim-only scale. This allowed us to obtain bully and victim data simultaneously for each participant. The former NAQ-R items were reworded to accommodate the bully-and-victim format. For example, the original NAQ-R item 1, “Someone withholding information which affects your performance,” became “Withheld information which affects job performance.” This item and others (1–22) were followed by columns headed “Others did to me,” and “I did to others,” (a format employed previously by Lee & Brotheridge, 2006) to gather data on targets and perpetrators, respectively. Table 1 shows the first three PTS items, illustrating the general strategy employed in the simultaneous testing of bullies and victims. Study participants were not required to

Table 1

Three items from the Perpetrator-Target Scale (PTS), illustrating the general strategy involved in simultaneous testing of bullies and victims.

1	2	3	4	5
Never	Now and then	Monthly	Weekly	Daily
	Others did to me		I did to others	
1. Withheld information which affects job performance				
2. Humiliated or ridiculed in connection with work				
3. Ordered to do work below level of competence				

Please indicate **how often you've had each of the following done to you** during the past 6 months of work.

Please indicate **how often you did each of the following to others** during the past 6 months of work.

For both steps, use the above scale.

self-identify as bully or victim, which could compromise objective responding (Einarsen et al., 2009). We refer to the derived measure as the Perpetrator-Target Scale or PTS to distinguish it from the original NAQ-R.

3. Results

3.1. Demographics

There were 158 females (70.5%), and 66 males (29.5%) included in the study. The mean age was 21.45 years ($SD = 4.89$), with a range of 18–47 years. Participants self-reported working an average of 29.83 hours weekly, had been with their present employer an average of 2.24 years, and had been in their current occupation an average of 2.34 years. Some 40.2% of the participants reported being employed full time. Demographic variables such as hours worked per week, years with current employer and occupation, occupation type age, employment status (i.e., full versus part-time), educational level, ethnicity, recruitment group (in terms of university and discipline/degree program), body height, and marital status were not significantly related to scores on the bully or victim subscales. Body weight was significantly correlated with the bully subscale, however, and remained so after controlling for gender ($r = .14$, $p = .05$). Separate bivariate analyses by gender showed that this association characterized the female ($r = .19$, $p = .02$), but not the male, subgroup.

3.2. Perpetrator-Target Scale (PTS)

Roughly 37.5% of participants who completed the PTS reported being victimized by negative acts at least once per week in the past 6 months. Approximately 17.4% reported perpetrating negative acts upon others by the same criteria. The mean scores on the bully and victim subscale items ranged from 1.04 to 1.70, and from 1.10 to 2.07, respectively. The overall subscale means and standard deviations are reproduced in Table 2.

Significantly higher scores were obtained on the victim ($M = 31.62$, $SD = 9.50$) than bully subscales ($M = 28.09$, $SD = 6.10$), $t(223) = 7.07$, $p < .001$, $d = .47$. There were no significant differences between males and females in terms of either bully, $t(222) = 1.21$, $p = .23$, or victim scores, $t(222) = 0.64$, $p = .52$. A substantive correlation, $r = .62$ ($p < .001$), was obtained between the bully and victim subscales, suggesting that bullying others and being a victim were strongly associated (see Table 2).

Both the bully and victim subscales of the PTS possess high internal consistency ($\alpha = .84$ and $.89$, respectively), with alpha failing to improve upon removal of any of the 22 items. The construct validity of the bully subscale was supported through associations with general aggression measures (e.g., BPAQ-SF Anger, Hostility, and Verbal Aggression), and personality traits previously observed

as positive bullying correlates (Machiavellianism, narcissism). In addition, we have obtained a correlation of $r = .62$ ($p < .001$) between the PTS bully subscale and the 6-item Workplace Bullying Scale (Parkins et al., 2006), another measure of bullying others (Linton & Power, unpublished results). The notion of a positive relationship between bully and victim scores was supported by a significant correlation between the PTS victim subscale and the Workplace Bullying Scale ($r = .34$, $p < .001$).

3.3. Personality variables

The mean scores, standard deviations, and Pearson product-moment correlations are presented for the PTS and personality variables in Table 2. Consistent with study hypotheses, Machiavellianism, narcissism, EPQ-R Psychoticism, the BPAQ-SF aggression subscales, and BSSS Disinhibition correlated significantly with the PTS bully subscale. Hypotheses for the overall Brief Sensation Seeking Scale (BSSS) and Boredom Susceptibility were not supported for bullies. Also consistent with study hypotheses, Machiavellianism, narcissism, EPQ-R Psychoticism, and the BPAQ-SF aggression subscales correlated significantly with the PTS victim subscale. Hypotheses concerning BSSS overall scale scores, Disinhibition and Boredom Susceptibility were not supported for victims. Correlations with the bully-typifying traits tended to be of lower magnitude for victims than bullies. Psychoticism, hostility, and verbal aggression, however, were notable as their correlations with the victim and bully subscales were very similar (psychoticism obtained 0.32 and 0.35, hostility obtained 0.21 and 0.22, and verbal aggression obtained 0.25 and 0.26, for victims and bullies, respectively). Correlations between the bully-typifying traits, and PTS bully subscales created to correspond with NAQ-R-derived factors (work-related bullying, personal bullying and physically intimidating bullying), were similar to those observed between the bully-typifying traits and the bully subscale of the PTS. For each subscale, correlations with Machiavellianism, narcissism and psychoticism exceeded those for the BPAQ aggression variables, which in turn exceeded those for the BSSS sensation seeking variables.

3.4. Results of hierarchical regression on the bully subscale

To examine the contributions of other subtypes of bully-typifying variables (BPAQ-SF aggression, BSSS sensation seeking), after Machiavellianism, narcissism, and psychoticism had been entered, hierarchical multiple regression analyses were utilized. Separate analyses were performed for the bully and the victim subscales. Tolerance values of 0.77–0.92 (>0.10) and variance inflation factors of 1.09–1.29 (<10.00) for the regressed variables suggest that error due to multicollinearity is unlikely.

Step 1 of a 3-step hierarchical regression procedure predicted bullying scores from Machiavellianism, narcissism, and psychoti-

Table 2

Means, standard deviations (SD), and Pearson product-moment correlations of study variables.

Variable	Mean (SD)	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10
1. Victim subscale	31.62 (9.50)										
2. Bully subscale	28.09 (6.10)	0.62***									
3. Machiavellianism	2.02 (2.20)	0.26***	0.44***								
4. Narcissism	2.77 (1.98)	0.19**	0.38***	0.53***							
5. Psychoticism	4.28 (2.75)	0.32***	0.35***	0.39***	0.33***						
6. Anger	2.08 (1.04)	0.19**	0.29***	0.25***	0.11	0.33***					
7. Hostility	2.55 (0.98)	0.21***	0.22***	0.24***	−0.05	0.24***	0.58***				
8. Verbal aggression	2.55 (0.92)	0.25***	0.26***	0.31***	0.32***	0.32***	0.45***	0.29***			
9. BSSS Sensation seeking total	26.50 (5.78)	0.07	0.08	0.23***	0.17*	0.44***	0.25***	0.14*	0.09		
10. Boredom susceptibility	3.46 (0.85)	0.06	0.10	0.19**	0.14*	0.27***	0.21***	0.09	0.15*	0.63***	
11. Disinhibition	2.96 (1.02)	0.12	0.19**	0.27***	0.23***	0.45***	0.30***	0.22***	0.19**	0.78***	0.36***

* $p < .05$.** $p < .01$.*** $p < .001$.

cism. R^2 for step 1 was .29, a value that was highly significant, $F(3,217) = 28.93$, $p < .001$. In step 2, the BPAQ-SF aggression variables, and in step 3, the sensation seeking variables (boredom susceptibility and disinhibition) failed to significantly increase the proportion of explained variance in the bullying variable, with R^2 changes of .02 and .003, respectively. Table 3 shows regression coefficients, along with significance tests.

3.5. Results of hierarchical regression on the victim subscale

Step 1 of a 3-step hierarchical regression procedure predicted victim scores from Machiavellianism, narcissism, and psychoticism. R^2 for step 1 was .13, a value that was highly significant, $F(3,217) = 11.10$, $p < .001$. Machiavellianism and psychoticism were significant predictors in this model. In step 2, the BPAQ-SF aggression variables, and in step 3, the sensation seeking variables (boredom susceptibility and disinhibition) failed to significantly increase the proportion of explained variance in the bullying variable, with R^2 changes of .03 and .006, respectively. See Table 3.

Table 3

Hierarchical regression analyses predicting bully and victim subscale scores..

	Bully subscale scores β	Victim subscale scores β
Predictor		
Step 1		
Machiavellianism	0.32***	0.16*
Narcissism	0.15*	0.04
Psychoticism	0.20**	0.24***
Step 2		
Machiavellianism	0.28***	0.11
Narcissism	0.18*	0.06
Psychoticism	0.16*	0.20**
Anger	0.1	0
Hostility	0.06	0.13
Verbal aggression	0.01	0.1
Step 3		
Machiavellianism	0.28***	0.11
Narcissism	0.17*	0.07
Psychoticism	0.18*	0.23**
Anger	0.1	0.13
Hostility	0.07	0.13
Verbal aggression	−0.01	0.1
Boredom susceptibility	0.05	0
Disinhibition	−0.06	−0.09

Note: Bully subscale: $R^2 = .29$ *** for Step 1; $\Delta R^2 = .02$ for Step 2; $\Delta R^2 = .003$ for Step 3. Victim subscale: $R^2 = .13$ *** for Step 1; $\Delta R^2 = .03$ for Step 2; $\Delta R^2 = .006$ for Step 3.

* $p < .05$.** $p < .01$.*** $p < .001$.

3.6. Bully/victim analysis

To investigate a possible explanation for the expression of bully-typifying traits in victims, the prevalence of bully/victims was calculated. Bully/victims were defined as those who had been both perpetrators and targets of negative events at least once weekly during the past 6 months. Bully/victims comprised 15.6% of the overall study sample. Here, we found that a substantive 41.7% of victims and 89.7% of bullies were also bully/victims.

We then examined whether bully/victims possess higher mean scores than non-bully/victims on the bully-typifying personality traits Machiavellianism, narcissism, and EPQ-R Psychoticism (selected because of their predictive value in the correlational and regression analyses). Bully/victims were categorized as those who scored above the median on both the PTS bully and victim subscales, while non-bully/victims were categorized as those who scored below the median on at least one of the two subscales. Means and standard deviations for bully/victims and non-bully/victims were calculated at an adjusted alpha level of .016 (.05/3) to minimize type 1 error. Table 4 demonstrates significantly higher mean scores for bully/victims on each trait.

4. Discussion

This study is unique in demonstrating that bullies and victims share a wide range of bully-typifying personality traits. These traits were investigated using a 22-item scale derived from the victim-oriented NAQ-R, which was modified to simultaneously measure bullies and victims. Bullying was associated with Machiavellianism, narcissism, EPQ-R Psychoticism, BPAQ-SF aggression subscales, and BSSS Disinhibition. More strikingly, the majority of bully-typifying traits (Machiavellianism, narcissism, psychoticism, and the aggression measures) were associated with being a victim. These correlations tended to be of lower magnitude for victims than bullies, although hostility, psychoticism, and verbal aggression bore correlations with the victim and bully subscales that were of very similar effect size.

Table 4

Means and standard deviations for Machiavellianism, narcissism, and psychoticism by bully/victim status.

	Bully/victim M (SD)	Non-bully/victim M (SD)	t	Cohen's d
Machiavellianism	2.95 (2.64)	1.49 (1.71)	4.59***	0.63
Narcissism	3.32 (2.19)	2.43 (1.78)	3.19**	0.44
Psychoticism	5.20 (2.72)	3.71 (2.63)	4.06***	0.56

** $p < .01$.*** $p < .001$.

The prevalence of bullying was similar to that observed in previous studies. Our finding that 37.5% of participants reported being victimized, once per week in the past 6 months, falls between the values of 46.8% for American, and 24.1% for Finnish employees, meeting the same frequency criteria (Lutgen-Sandvik et al., 2007; Salin, 2001). The finding that 17.4% of participants reported perpetrating negative acts corresponds with the 24% value reported by Lee and Brotheridge (2006), who used a measure that included NAQ items. Our observation that bully/victims comprised 15.6% of the study sample corresponds with the 20% figure reported by Lee and Brotheridge (2006), who also measured bullies and victims simultaneously. In addition, our finding that 41.7% of victims and 89.7% of bullies were bully/victims corresponds with the 50% of victims and 83% of bullies described by Lee and Brotheridge (2006).

The .89 Cronbach alpha obtained for the PTS victim subscale falls within the high-end of the .81–.92 range of alphas reported by Lutgen-Sandvik et al. (2007) for NAQ measures. The .86 alpha for the more novel PTS bully subscale also fits well within this range. The findings that the bully subscale of the PTS related positively to aggression measures, previously established personality correlates of bullying such as Machiavellianism and narcissism, and the Workplace Bullying Scale (Parkins et al., 2006), provided support for the validity of the PTS bully subscale. The average correlation of Machiavellianism, narcissism, and EPQ-R Psychoticism with the PTS ($r = .38$), was similar in magnitude to the corresponding average for Baughman et al.'s (2012) dark triad variables with their Bullying Questionnaire ($r = .37$). The correlation of .62, obtained between the bully and victim subscales of the PTS, mirrors the .63 correlation between bully and victim subscales reported by Lee and Brotheridge (2006).

Machiavellianism, narcissism, and EPQ-R Psychoticism ranked as the highest magnitude personality predictors of bullying others, and accounted for a substantive 29% of the variance in bully subscale scores when entered as the first step in a hierarchical regression analysis. These variables are considered particularly socially aversive among subclinical personality traits (Eysenck & Eysenck, 1994). Taken together, this “alternative dark triad” is associated with antisocial behavior, grandiosity, self-entitlement, manipulation, aggression, hostility, low empathy, interpersonal conflict, and cruelty. Consequently, it should be no surprise that these traits are so prominently linked with bullying others. Indeed, in our hierarchical regressions, the BPAQ and BSSS variables failed to contribute significantly to variation in the dependent variables beyond that accounted for by these three traits. Psychoticism and Machiavellianism were also significant predictors of victimization in a hierarchical regression step that accounted for 13% of the variance in victim subscale scores.

The aggression measures were associated, as expected, with both bully and victim behavior. We thus extend previous findings regarding BPAQ Anger, Verbal Aggression, and Hostility by demonstrating associations with victim as well as bully scores on the PTS. Palmer and Thakordas (2005) found only Hostility, among the BPAQ aggression scales, to be associated with victim scores in imprisoned male offenders. This disparity may be due to scale and/or sample differences; we have, however, replicated our correlational findings for the BPAQ-SF subscales and the PTS in other samples (Linton & Power, unpublished results).

The sensation seeking subscale, BSSS Disinhibition, was significantly related to bullying others, but demonstrated only a nonsignificant positive trend among victims in this study. Disinhibition has been associated with each of the BPAQ aggression subscales (Zuckerman, 2007). The sensation seeking motive should be further explored as a contributor to bullying activity.

The accumulating evidence that many victims are also bullies, that is, bully/victims, helps to explain why victims share the bully-typifying traits of bullies. We supported this position by

demonstrating that bully/victims score significantly higher than non-bully/victims on Machiavellianism, narcissism, and psychoticism. In fact, sporadic observations suggest that bully/victims may possess higher scores on other bully-typifying traits, such as aggression (Matthiesen & Einarsen, 2007). It has been argued that certain personality traits increase the likelihood of their bearers becoming targets of bullying by others (Andersson & Pearson, 1999; Archer et al., 2007). In the complex supertrait EPQ-R Psychoticism, a variety of factors, including general disagreeableness, cruelty, hostility, impulsiveness, and a disregard for social conventions, rules, and feelings of others, may be among the features that elicit a bullying response from others.

The weak correlation observed between body weight and bully subscale scores requires independent replication. One study found obese high school females three times more likely to bully others than their normal-weight counterparts (Kukaswadia, Craig, Janssen, & Pickett, 2011).

Limitations of this study include the use of university undergraduates as subjects, who often hold entry-level jobs, and whose bullying profiles may not be directly generalizable to other populations. Future studies may wish to broaden this demographic. EPQ-R Psychoticism demonstrated a somewhat low Cronbach alpha. The obtained value of .66, however, corresponds very closely with figures provided by Eysenck and Eysenck (1994), and was the mean value for 69 samples from 44 studies analyzed by Caruso, Witkiewitz, Belcourt-Dittloff, and Gottlieb (2001). High factorial heterogeneity has been cited by Eysenck and Eysenck (1994) as a basis for the lower alpha values.

Future work should include simultaneous measurement of bullies and victims with respect to broad, higher-order personality dimensions (e.g., EPQ-R, five factor model), and the continued investigation of specific bully, victim, and bully/victim predictors. Although we present reliability and validity data, and expect that the PTS would share many psychometric qualities with the original NAQ-R, this instrument stands as a novel measure that lacks extensive characterization. Researchers are urged to consider a wider range of personality variables with respect to research on victims. The observation that bully/victims relate substantially to bullying activity suggests that researchers and employers should acknowledge this group in their efforts to understand and reduce bullying in the workplace.

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